The Vending Location Scouting Checklist

Walk the location, score it honestly, run the math before you sign anything. One page, print it, take it with you.

1 · Walk-Through Checklist

SLOT	WHAT TO CHECK	SCORE 1–5
A1	**Daily foot traffic** — count people passing the proposed spot during a normal shift, not just at lunch.	☐
A2	**Dwell time** — do people linger nearby (breakroom, waiting area) or just pass through in seconds?	☐
A3	**Competing options nearby** — other vending machines, a cafeteria, a vending-friendly gas station within walking distance?	☐
B1	**Staff / population count** — how many employees, residents, or regular visitors actually use this breakroom or hallway?	☐
B2	**Hours of access** — is the machine reachable 24/7, or only during business hours (limits restock flexibility)?	☐
B3	**Power outlet availability** — is there a grounded outlet within reach, or will you need an extension run or electrician?	☐
C1	**Who signs off** — facilities manager, owner, HOA board? Get the decision-maker's name and confirm they can actually approve it.	☐

Scoring guide: 25–35 = strong location, worth pursuing. 15–24 = marginal, negotiate hard on commission or pass. Under 15 = walk away.

2 · Per-Location Profit Worksheet

Line item	Your numbers	Example ILLUSTRATIVE ONLY
Sales per day		20 sales/day
Average sale price		$1.50
Gross margin (price minus product cost, before commission)		60%
Monthly gross margin dollars (sales/day × price × margin × 30)		20 × $1.50 × 60% × 30 = **$540**
Location commission (% of gross revenue paid to the site)		15% of $900 gross = $135
Worked example: $540 gross margin – $135 commission – restock/travel cost (estimate your own) = your net monthly figure for this stop. Numbers above are round, illustrative placeholders — not a promised outcome. Plug in your real observed traffic and pricing.		
Your net monthly profit for this location		—

3 · Commission Negotiation

- Commissions are commonly in the **10–25%** range of gross sales — everything is negotiable, especially at a new or unproven stop.
- Offer a lower commission on a trial period (60–90 days), then revisit once you have real sales data to show.
- Flat monthly rent is sometimes preferred by the location over a % cut — compare both before agreeing.
- Free product for a breakroom occasionally beats cash commission for smaller sites — ask what they'd actually value.
- Get the agreed rate and term in writing, even if it's a one-page email confirmation.

4 · Red Flags

- Location asks **you** to pay upfront for placement rights or a "slot fee."
- Building is known to be relocating, closing, or under lease renegotiation soon.
- Decision-maker won't confirm authority to approve the placement in writing.
- No stable, accessible power source without major electrical work.
- Facility already has an exclusive vending contract you weren't told about.